

DAYANARA M. DIAZ VARGAS

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PRIMARY FIELD

Health Economics

SECONDARY FIELD

Labor Economics

DESIRED TEACHING FIELDS:

Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Introduction to Econometrics, Microeconomic Theory, Industrial Organization, Labor Economics, Health Economics

EDUCATION:

May 2027	Ph.D., Economics, Northeastern University (<i>expected</i>)
May 2022	M.S., Economics, Northeastern University
December 2019	M.B.A., Business Administration, University of Puerto Rico
May 2017	B.A., Economics (Magna Cum Laude), University of Puerto Rico

JOB MARKET PAPER:

Diaz Vargas, Dayanara. “**Healthcare Privatization and Patient Health: Evidence from Puerto Rico.**” Job Market Paper, 2026. [Draft]

Abstract: This paper estimates the effects on population health of shifting a large publicly financed healthcare system from direct public provision to private management. We study Puerto Rico’s 1994–2000 health reform, which combined changes in facility control, payment incentives, eligibility, and access. Exploiting the reform’s staggered rollout across counties, we estimate an increase in all-cause mortality of 26.96 deaths per 100,000 residents annually, equivalent to 3.7 percent of the pre-treatment mean. The mortality increase is accompanied by a contraction in ambulatory healthcare services, fewer hospitals, and lower use of early prenatal care, consistent with reduced provider capacity and access to timely care as possible mechanisms. The estimated mortality increase persists across alternative specifications and identification strategies. These findings suggest health costs from a broad reorganization of publicly financed care and support evaluating patient outcomes and provider capacity alongside expenditure when assessing transitions to private management.

WORKING PAPERS:

Diaz Vargas, Dayanara. “**Corporate Tax Incentives Retraction: Evidence from Puerto Rico.**” Working Paper, 2026. [Draft]

Abstract: We know much about the effects of introducing place-based tax incentives for corporations. Given how costly these incentives are, we know surprisingly little about their effects once they are retracted. To fill this gap, this paper studies the retraction of one of the costliest corporate tax incentives in the United States, Section 936 of the U.S. Internal Revenue Code. This incentive exempted U.S. corporations from federal tax on income earned in Puerto Rico from 1976 until Congress phased it out beginning in 1996 and eliminated it in 2006. Manufacturing claimed 98 percent of the tax credits and produced a median 45.5 percent of island GDP at the time, making it one of the most important industries in the economy. Using synthetic difference-in-differences on employment data for Puerto Rico and U.S. states, this paper estimates that manufacturing employment fell 9.2 percent by 2000, 13.3 percent by the close of the phase-out in 2005, and 28.0 percent by 2019, relative to the counterfactual. Results show no return to baseline employment levels two decades later. The average county-level decline is 13.6 percent, and reaches 18.2 percent in high-poverty counties. This evidence leads us to conclude that even after

three decades of tax subsidy, the retraction of place-based tax incentives fails to ignite self-sustaining industries.

WORK IN PROGRESS:

“Physician Migration from Puerto Rico and the Health of Receiving Communities” (with Jori Barash, University of Oregon)

Abstract: This paper studies whether physician arrivals improve healthcare access and population health in receiving communities. Physicians’ location choices make it difficult to distinguish the effects of physician supply from differences in local healthcare demand. We examine physician migration from Puerto Rico to mainland U.S. counties following Hurricane Maria in September 2017. Our proposed instrumental variables strategy uses the pre-hurricane geographic distribution of the Puerto Rican diaspora to predict physician arrivals. Using data from 2012 to 2022, we study hospital use, preventable hospitalizations, access to care, and mortality, with attention to differences across physician specialties.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE:

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| Summer 2024 | Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Northeastern University
Dr. John Kwoka. Built case records on concluded FTC antitrust matters for a retrospective study of remedy effectiveness. |
| 2021–2024 | Research Assistant, D’Amore-McKim School of Business, Northeastern University
Dr. Shawn Bhimani. Supply Trace project. Led a team of four research assistants tracing apparel production networks. |
| Spring 2023 | Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Northeastern University
Dr. Bilge Erten. Collected and analyzed data for Dave, Erten, Keskin, and Zhang, <i>Journal of Health Economics</i> 104 (2025), 103073. |

TEACHING EXPERIENCE:

Recitation Leader, Department of Economics, Northeastern University

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| 2024–2026 | <i>Principles of Macroeconomics</i> (ECON 1115; recitation ECON 1125)
Course enrollment: 400 Four recitation sections per term, two in Spring 2026
Independently designed and taught a weekly discussion on the course material, integrating macroeconomic theory with current news and relevant applications, including original presentations and examples. Supervised, guided, and graded students’ case study projects on macroeconomic issues. Held office hours and graded problem sets, discussion boards, and exams. |
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Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, Northeastern University

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| Spring 2026 | <i>Microeconomic Theory</i> (ECON 2316) |
| Summer 2025 | <i>Statistics for Economists</i> (ECON 2350) |
| Summer 2024 | <i>Contested Economic Issues</i> (ECON 1260) |
| Fall 2023 | <i>Applied Econometrics</i> (ECON 2560), two sections |
| Spring 2023 | <i>Microeconomic Theory</i> (ECON 2316) |
| Spring 2023 | <i>Global Political Economy</i> (INTL 3520) |
- Across these courses, graded problem sets, proctored exams, and led office hours.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE:

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| July 2025 | Ignite@AG Extern, Analysis Group, Boston, MA
Selected as one of 14 externs from 400 applicants. Led a carriage dispute case exercise. |
| 2019–2021 | Quantitative Analyst, Enterprise Risk Management, FirstBank Puerto Rico
Validated econometric, financial, and machine learning models and certified model documentation. |

2019 Economist and Researcher, Inteligencia Economica Inc., Guaynabo, PR
Wrote feasibility studies for small businesses, international corporations, and government institutions.

GRANTS AND FUNDING:

2021 David A. Radivonyk Fund for Student Research in Economics, Northeastern University (\$1,000)
2017–2019 Damaso “Tom” Acevedo Endowment Fund, University of Puerto Rico (\$1,500)

FELLOWSHIPS AND HONORS:

2022–2027 Ph.D. Excellence Fellowship, Northeastern University. Three summers of full funding and a \$2,500 research allowance.
2026 Participant, AEA Mentoring Program and the AEA Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP)

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS:

“Healthcare Privatization and Patient Health: Evidence from Puerto Rico” (Job Market Paper)

November 2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA (*scheduled*)
2026 American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference, Minneapolis, MN

“Corporate Tax Incentives Retraction: Evidence from Puerto Rico”

November 2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference, Boston, MA (*scheduled*)
2026 AEA Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference, Washington, DC
2024–2026 Economics Workshop, Department of Economics, Northeastern University (once per semester, including Summer)
2024 Development Reading Group, Boston University

REFERENCES:

Dr. Shantanu Khanna (Chair), Assistant Professor of Public Policy and Economics, Northeastern University, s.khanna@northeastern.edu
Dr. James Dana, Professor of Economics and Strategy, Department of Economics and D’Amore-McKim School of Business, Northeastern University, j.dana@northeastern.edu
Dr. Mindy Marks, Associate Professor, Department of Economics, Northeastern University, m.marks@northeastern.edu
Dr. Jill Dupree (Teaching Reference), Associate Teaching Professor of Economics, Northeastern University, j.dupree@northeastern.edu

OTHER INFORMATION:

Software: R, Python, SQL, Stata, JavaScript, LaTeX

Professional Memberships: American Economic Association; American Society of Health Economists; American Society of Hispanic Economists; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management

Languages: Spanish (native), English (native), French (basic), Portuguese (Where is the bathroom?)

Citizenship: United States